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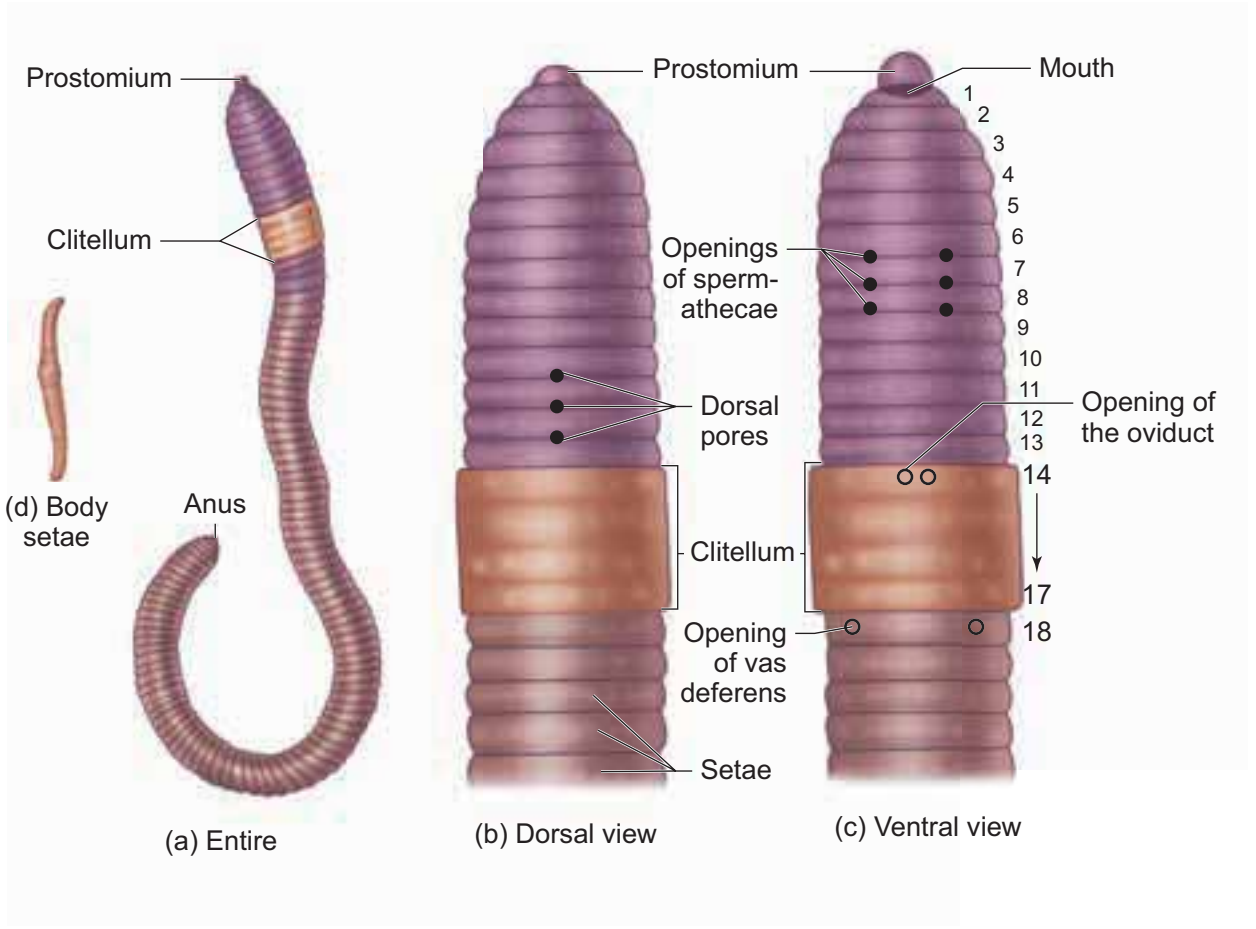


Figure 4.2 *Lampito mauritii*

of the body, called the **peristomium**. Overhanging the mouth is a small flap called the upper lip or **prostomium**. The last segment has the anus called the **pygidium.** In mature worms, segments 14 to 17 may be found swollen with a glandular thickening of the skin called the **clitellum**. This helps in the formation of the cocoon. Due to the presence of clitellum, the body of an earthworm is divided into pre clitellar region (1st – 13th segments), clitellar region (14th – 17th segments) and the post – clitellar region (after the 17th segment). In all the segments of the body except the first, last and clitellum, there is a ring of chitinous body setae. This body setae arises from a setigerous sac of the skin and it is curved as **S** – shaped. Setae can be protruded or retracted and their principal role is in locomotion.

The external apertures are the mouth, anus, dorsal pores, spermathecal openings, genital openings and nephridiopores. The dorsal pores are present from the 10th segment onwards. The coelomic fluid communicates to the exterior through these pores and keeps the body surface moist and free from harmful microorganisms. Spermathecal openings are three pairs of small ventrolateral apertures lying intersegmentally between the grooves of the segments 6/7, 7/8 and 8/9. The female genital aperture lies on the ventral side in the 14th segment and a pair of male genital apertures are situated latero-ventrally in the 18th segment.